

LINDSAY A. GRAEF

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APPOINTMENTS

- 2026-present Research Director, Penn Prosecution Lab
Quattrone Center for the Fair Administration of Justice,
University of Pennsylvania Carey Law School
- 2024-2026 Postdoctoral Fellow
Quattrone Center for the Fair Administration of Justice,
University of Pennsylvania Carey Law School

EDUCATION

- 2024 PhD in Criminology, *University of Pennsylvania*, Philadelphia, PA
MS in Statistics, *University of Pennsylvania*, Philadelphia, PA
- 2019 MPP, *University of California Los Angeles*, Los Angeles, CA
Thesis (Highest Honors): *Establishing a Consent Policy for Youth Diversion in Los Angeles County*
MSW, *University of California Los Angeles*, Los Angeles, CA
- 2011 BFA, *University of Nebraska-Lincoln*, Lincoln, NE

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- 2021-2023 UPenn Center for Teaching and Learning: Certificate in College and University Teaching
- 2022-2023 Quantitative Methods for Public Policy (TA for 2 semesters, taught own lab)
- 2021 Undergraduate Capstone Research in Criminal Justice Policy (TA)
- 2019 Methods of Policy Analysis (TA)
- 2018-2019 Statistical Methods of Policy Analysis II (TA, taught own lab)
- 2018 Statistical Methods of Policy Analysis I (TA, taught own lab)
- 2013-2015 Fulbright English Teaching Assistant in Indonesia

PUBLICATIONS

- Nguyen, V., & Graef, L. (2026). [The Net-Narrowing Potential of Diversion: A Theoretical and Empirical Assessment of Prosecutor-led, Adult Diversion](#). Forthcoming in *Criminology*.
- Graef, L., & Ouss, A. (2025). [The Role of Case Management in Misdemeanor Prosecution](#). *Criminology*.
- Graef, L., Mayson, S., Stevenson, M. T., & Ouss, A. (2023). [Systemic Failure to Appear in Court](#). *University of Pennsylvania Law Review*, 172(1).

WORKING PAPERS & ONGOING RESEARCH

- “Bench Warrants as an Institutional Response to Failure to Appear” (with Michael Zanger-Tishler) – *Revise and Resubmit at the Journal of Legal Studies*
- “Prosecutors as Case Managers” – *Revise and Resubmit at Law & Society Review*

“Prosecutor Backgrounds and Charging Decisions” (with Paul Heaton and Greg Ridgeway)

“Personnel and Policy: Disentangling Mechanisms in Prosecutorial Change” (with Aurélie Ouss, Marit Rehavi, and Eden Ralph)

WHITE PAPERS & CONSULTING

Nguyen, V., & Graef, L. (2025). [Low-touch, Misdemeanor Diversion Programs with Record Expungement Reduce Reconviction Rates](#). University of Pennsylvania Carey Law School.

Graef, L., & Ouss, A. (2025). The Role of Case Management in Low-level Prosecution. University of Pennsylvania Carey Law School.

Graef, L., Mayson, S., Stevenson, M. T., & Ouss, A. (2023). [Court No-Shows: A Systemic Issue](#). University of Pennsylvania Carey Law School.

Gong, G., Obiora, A., Bentley, A., & Audet, E. (2023). [Mayor to Mayor: Taking the Lead on Police Accountability](#). Harvard Government Performance Lab. (project contributor)

Rafiq, H. (2023). [Building a Responsive Pretrial Supervision System in Harris County, Texas](#). Harvard Government Performance Lab. (project contributor)

Baik, S., Gilliam, O., Graef, L., Lewis, N., & Webster, E. (2020). Establishing a Consent Policy for Youth Diversion in Los Angeles County. *California Policy Options 2020*.

MEDIA

Op-eds

- *Too many Philly police are no-shows in court, derailing cases and undermining our justice system*. [The Philadelphia Inquirer](#), Nov. 2023
- *Officers' Failure to Appear in Court Undermines Justice*, [Law360](#), May 2024

Articles focusing on my research

- *Private criminal defense lawyers failed to show up for their cases more often than defendants, Philly study finds*, [The ABA Journal](#), Nov. 2023
- *Showing up for Court*, [Advancing Pretrial Policy and Research](#), April 2024

Media Mentions

- Systemic Failure to Appear in Court: [The Philadelphia Inquirer](#)

SELECTED GRANTS

2025	<i>Building Prosecutorial Infrastructure to Understand Criminal Justice Reform</i> , Arnold Ventures, \$906,731
2025	<i>Declining to Prosecute and Reducing Supervision: The Impacts of Prosecutor-driven Reforms</i> , Arnold Ventures, \$197,513
2023	<i>Prosecutors in the Misdemeanor Courts</i> , Association of Doctoral Programs in Criminology and Criminal Justice (ADPCCJ), \$1,000

PRESENTATIONS

2026	UC Irvine Summit on Prosecution
2025	Guest Lectures at Duke Law School, UPenn Economics, and UPenn Criminology; American Society of Criminology (ASC) Annual Meeting

2024	Duke Empirical Criminal Law Roundtable; Law and Society Association Annual Meeting; Workshop on Economics of Crime for Junior Scholars (WEC Jr.); Quattrone Center Spring Symposium; Guest Lecture at UPenn Criminology
2023	Continuing Legal Education for prosecutors at the Philadelphia District Attorney's Office; ASC Annual Meeting; Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) Annual Meeting; Conference on Empirical Legal Studies (CELS); Quattrone Center Spring Symposium; Philadelphia DAO Research to Action Event
2022	ASC Annual Meeting; Conference on Empirical Legal Studies; Philadelphia District Attorney's Office
2021	ASC Annual Meeting

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Reviewer	Law & Society Review, Journal of Policy Analysis and Management, Journal of Empirical Legal Studies, Journal of Criminal Justice
Organizer	Quattrone Center Spring Symposium (host committee), PSU/UPenn/UMD Virtual Conference, UPenn Criminology PhD Student Seminar

Equity and Inclusion

2022	<i>Mini-course on Inclusive and Equitable Teaching</i> , University of Pennsylvania
2019-2020	<i>Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) Taskforce</i> , HKS Government Performance Lab
2017-2019	<i>Policy Professionals for Diversity and Equity (PPDE)</i> , UCLA, Development Chair

HONORS AND AWARDS

2023	<i>Honorable Mention</i> , Conference on Empirical Legal Studies (CELS) Poster Competition
2022	<i>Honorable Mention</i> , Conference on Empirical Legal Studies (CELS) Poster Competition
2019	<i>MPP Student of the Year</i> , University of California Los Angeles
2019	<i>Distinguished Teaching Assistant Award</i> , University of California Los Angeles
2019	<i>Department Leadership and Service Award</i> , University of California Los Angeles
2019	<i>Outstanding Academic Achievement Award</i> , University of California Los Angeles
2018	<i>Calvin and Marilyn Gross Fellowship</i> , University of California Los Angeles
2018	<i>Hilton Foundation Fellowship</i> , University of California Los Angeles
2016-2019	<i>Luskin Graduate Fellowship</i> , University of California Los Angeles
2007-2011	<i>Regents Scholarship</i> , University of Nebraska-Lincoln

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

R, Python, STATA, JavaScript, LaTeX, Adobe Creative Suite, Adobe InDesign
English (native), Indonesian (intermediate proficiency), Spanish (basic proficiency)

RELATED PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

<i>Harvard Kennedy School Government Performance Lab</i> , Houston, TX	6/2019 – 12/2023
Consultant and Government Innovation Fellow , embedded in Harris County Pretrial Services Agency	
<i>UCLA Graduate Writing Center</i> , Los Angeles, CA	8/2017 – 12/2018
Graduate Writing Consultant	
<i>Office of Los Angeles County Supervisor Sheila Kuehl</i> , Los Angeles, CA	6/2018 – 9/2018
Graduate Fellow	

<i>Los Angeles Area Chamber of Commerce, Los Angeles, CA</i> MSW Intern with UNITE-LA's Smart Justice Team and L.A. Compact	6/2017 – 8/2017
<i>Coalition for Engaged Education, Santa Monica, CA</i> MSW Intern at Probation Camp David Gonzales	9/2016 – 6/2017
<i>Lincoln Literacy, Lincoln, NE</i> Program Coordinator	8/2015 – 8/2016
<i>Fulbright Scholar in Indonesia, Kupang, NTT and Banjarmasin, South Kalimantan</i> Fulbright English Teaching Assistant (ETA) and Returning Fulbright ETA	8/2013 – 6/2015